

BRUCE BJOSTAD

Software Engineer · Full-Stack · AI Applications

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with 10+ years in enterprise software, from resolving authentication, performance, and API issues across Tableau's platform to co-founding an agentic AI startup. Since 2024, designed and built four products solo with React, React Native, Spring Boot, Node.js, and GCP, owning each from architecture through launch.

SKILLS

Languages: Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, SQL, Dart, HTML/CSS

Front End: React, React Native (Expo), Tailwind CSS, Vite, Konva, Skia, D3.js, Recharts, Flutter

Back End: Spring Boot, Spring Security, Node.js, REST APIs, Server-Sent Events, webhooks, LangChain

Data: PostgreSQL, Firestore, SQLite (WatermelonDB)

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Route 53, CloudFormation), GCP (Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, Cloud Build, Secret Manager), Firebase, Cloudflare Pages, Docker, Git

AI & Integrations: OpenAI API, Gemini API, Google Drive & Sheets APIs, RevenueCat

Auth & Security: OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, SAML, JWT

IoT: MQTT, Zigbee, Home Assistant

EXPERIENCE

Independent Software Engineer

Feb 2026 – Present

Staryteller — AI bedtime story app

Jan 2024 – Present

- Developed a React Native (Expo) and TypeScript app that writes personalized bedtime stories with an LLM and adds each one as a star in a growing constellation, backed by a Spring Boot 3 API on GCP Cloud Run and Cloud SQL (PostgreSQL); in testing.
- Streamed story generation from the OpenAI API to the app over Server-Sent Events, with moderation pre-checks, per-tier daily quotas, and RevenueCat webhooks that keep subscription tiers in sync.
- Rendered the constellation as an interactive Skia canvas with Reanimated gestures and deterministic hash-based star placement; stored data offline-first in WatermelonDB with last-write-wins sync to PostgreSQL.

9T9 Club — Team performance & playbook platform

Nov 2025 – Present

- Created a multi-sport platform for high school and college programs that turns combine results into 1–99 player ratings with a logistic-curve rating engine, using React 19, TypeScript, Vite, Tailwind CSS, and Firebase; in limited beta with 2 teams.
- Engineered an interactive 2D playbook editor with Konva, including route drawing, snap-to-line-of-scrimmage placement, saved formations, and play animation.
- Modeled a Firestore data layer with real-time listeners and role-based access, plus two-way Google Sheets sync via OAuth so coaches can keep their existing spreadsheets.

Gebo.ing — Universal wishlists & gift registries

Jul 2026 – Present

- Launched a full-stack wishlist and registry web app in about two months, using React on Cloudflare Pages with a Node.js and PostgreSQL backend; now in initial user testing.
- Implemented URL parsing that turns links from any retail site into list items, a one-click bookmarklet, and shareable public/private lists and event registries.

Lukk Boksen — Multiplayer mobile game

May 2026 – Present

- Wrote a Flutter/Dart Shut the Box game with invite-based asynchronous multiplayer, Forge2D dice physics, and shake-to-roll; distributed privately to a small group of players.
- Architected a serverless backend on the Google Drive and Sheets APIs, with game discovery, sharing permissions, and an append-only turn log stored in players' own accounts, so there are no servers to host or maintain.

SmartSherpa

Oct 2023 – Jan 2026

Co-Founder & Lead Software Engineer

- Designed, architected, and deployed an autonomous agentic AI platform that handled 24/7 customer engagement and lead qualification for service businesses (HVAC, plumbing, electrical) across SMS, voice, web chat, and Facebook Messenger.
- Led a team of three engineers building on AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Route 53, CloudFormation) with Java, Python, JavaScript, React, and LangChain.

- Engineered multi-channel conversational logic that qualified inbound leads and automated intake and troubleshooting, reducing client administrative overhead by 40%.
- Built industry-specific onboarding templates and knowledge bases for electricians and plumbers, cutting new-client deployment time by over 50%.

Tableau (Salesforce)

Jul 2015 – Mar 2023

System Engineer, Development

Jun 2019 – Mar 2023

- Led root-cause investigations of complex product defects affecting hundreds of at-risk enterprise customers, partnering with development teams to drive fixes.
- Developed and deployed interim workarounds that kept customers running until maintenance releases shipped.
- Served as subject matter expert for authentication (OpenID Connect, SAML), embedded analytics, and APIs.
- Resolved 50+ performance investigations as a member of the performance team.
- Cut low-quality incoming defects by 30% and sped resolution with triage templates and troubleshooting guides for Support.

Partner Engineer

Oct 2016 – May 2019

- Guided OEM partners' development teams through Tableau integrations; program-managed one partner's migration to Tableau, growing its licensing from 1,000 to 20,000+ users.
- Grew OEM support customer count 4x in 2 years with 98%+ satisfaction, across dozens of cloud and 500+ on-premise deployments, including air-gapped environments.

Senior Technical Support Engineer

Jul 2015 – Oct 2016

- Authored a global training course and documentation that improved logging and simplified OIDC configuration; beat SLA goals by starting a “case camp” for blocked cases.

Microsoft · Redmond, WA

Jul 2014 – Jun 2015

Service Engineer (Contract)

- Identified and resolved a data type overflow affecting global users, restoring Xbox Live to full functionality in under 2 hours.
- Improved uptime of core Xbox Live and legacy Windows Live services through monitoring with SCOM and custom scripts.

Earlier: SupportSpace (Remote), IT Consultant, 2010–2014 — selected as 1 of 10 Tier 2 “Gurus” from 600+ technicians.

PROJECTS

Freyr — Smart irrigation platform

Aug 2022 – Present

- Built a self-hosted smart irrigation system with a JavaScript/Node.js front end, Java/Spring Boot backend, and PostgreSQL, deployed with Docker.
- Fit a linear regression model (Apache Commons Math) on soil moisture, temperature, humidity, and weather forecasts to generate per-zone watering schedules, executed through Zigbee valves via Home Assistant and MQTT.
- In continuous use on a home garden since 2022; in the 2025 season, kept soil in optimal moisture range 94% of the time (vs. an estimated 43% without it) and saved an estimated 1,884 gallons of water and 36 hours of labor.
- Designing v2.0, replacing Home Assistant with a custom ESP32-based bridge to remove the third-party dependency.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science (ABET-accredited) · Western Governors University (WGU)